SIGMOID

COMPANY EVENT PARTICIPATION POLICY

SOP Name	Company Event Participation Policy
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Stakeholders	Employees and HR
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I. Purpose

The purpose of this Company Event Participation Policy is to clearly define the expectations for conduct, safety, and professionalism at all company-sponsored events. This policy ensures that these events remain positive, enjoyable, and inclusive experiences for all attendees while protecting the health, safety, and welfare of our employees, guests, and the company's reputation and assets. By establishing clear guidelines, the company aims to:

1. **Maintain Professional Standards:** Ensure that all conduct aligns with the company's core values and Code of Conduct.
2. **Ensure Safety and Compliance:** Promote a safe environment and ensure strict adherence to all applicable laws regarding alcohol consumption and substance use.
3. **Define Accountability:** Clearly outline the individual responsibilities of attendees concerning their behavior and adherence to all policies.

II. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and/or other invited guests while attending any company-sponsored events, off company premises, including but not limited to:

- **Social & Celebratory:** Holiday parties, anniversary celebrations, retirement parties, employee appreciation events etc
- **Team Building & Outings:** Departmental lunches or dinners, team-building activities, and CSR volunteer events.

- **Professional & Business:** Off-site meetings, company retreats, internal conferences, training seminars, and workshops.

- **External/Client-Related:** Industry conferences, trade shows, client dinners, and hospitality events where employees are representing the company.

- **Informal Gatherings:** Any gathering organized by employees where company funds are used, or where the company's name or property is associated with the event.

III. Employee Conduct and Professionalism

All attendees are required to uphold the highest standards of professional conduct and represent the company appropriately.

- **Adherence to Company Policies:** All standard company policies, including the Code of Conduct, Anti-Harassment, and Non-Discrimination policies, remain fully enforceable during all company events.

- **Respectful Interaction:** Attendees must treat all colleagues, guests, vendors, and event staff with courtesy, respect, and dignity. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, or the use of abusive or offensive language is strictly prohibited.

- **Appropriate Behavior:** Behavior must be conducive to a professional environment. Excessive noise, disorderly conduct, or any action that disrupts the event or negatively impacts the company's reputation is prohibited.

IV. Alcohol and Substance Policy

The company maintains a strong commitment to safety and adherence to all applicable laws regarding alcohol and substance use. Any consumption of alcohol by employees is entirely voluntary and is not a requirement for attendance or participation.

- **Responsible Alcohol Consumption:** If alcohol is provided, consumption must be strictly moderate and responsible.

- **Medical Considerations:** Employees who choose to consume alcohol or smoke cigarettes must take into consideration any pre-existing medical conditions, impairments, or prescription drug interactions for which they are liable.

- **Legal Compliance:** Only attendees who are of legal drinking age may consume alcohol.

- **Intoxication:** Employees are expected to showcase self-moderation while consuming alcohol. Visible intoxication, resulting in impaired judgment, inappropriate behavior, or disruption, is strictly prohibited and constitutes grounds for disciplinary action.

- **Illegal Substances:** The possession, use, sale, or distribution of illegal or controlled substances is absolutely prohibited on or near the event premises.

- **Impairment:** Employees must ensure that any use of prescription or over-the-counter medication does not impair their ability to act professionally or compromise the safety of themselves or others.

- **Safe Transportation:** Employees who consume any alcohol are strictly prohibited from operating a motor vehicle. Attendees must utilize alternative transportation (e.g., taxi, rideshare, designated driver) to ensure safe travel home.

V. Liability, Accountability, and Reporting

Employees are personally accountable for their actions and decisions while attending a company event.

- **Personal Responsibility:** The company assumes no liability for personal injuries, damages, or losses resulting from an employee's irresponsible behavior, violation of law, or misconduct.

- **Property Damage:** Employees are responsible for exercising due care with company-provided materials and the property of the event venue. Damage caused by intentional or negligent acts may result in the employee being held financially responsible.

- **Reporting Misconduct:** Employees are required to immediately report any behavior that violates this policy, poses a safety risk, or constitutes harassment to their direct manager, a member of Human Resources, or the senior company representative present at the event.

- **Post-Event Conduct:** Conduct occurring immediately before, during, or after the event that violates company policy or negatively affects the company's public image may still result in disciplinary action.

VI. Guests and Invitees

If the event permits employees to bring guests, the following rules apply:

- **Guest Accountability:** Employees are fully responsible for the conduct and adherence to this policy by their invited guest(s).

- **Policy Compliance:** Guests must comply with all aspects of this policy, particularly those concerning professional conduct, safety, and alcohol consumption.

- **Removal:** The company reserves the right to ask any guest to leave the event immediately if their behavior is deemed inappropriate, disruptive, or in violation of this policy.

VII. Expense Reimbursement and Spending

If expenses are incurred in connection with the event, they must comply with company standards.

- **Compliance with Policy:** All expenses incurred in relation to the event must strictly adhere to the company's established Expense Reimbursement Policy.

- **Prohibited Expenses:** Personal expenses, including excessive or unapproved drinks, or costs not directly related to the company's business purpose for the event, will not be reimbursed.

- **Company Funds:** The use of company funds or corporate credit cards for the purchase of illegal substances or excessive personal consumption is strictly prohibited and subject to immediate disciplinary action.

VIII. Dress Code and Professional Image

Employees must maintain an image that is appropriate for the nature of the event.

- **Appropriateness:** Attire must remain appropriate, professional, and non-offensive. Clothing that violates the spirit of the company's professional standards is prohibited.

IX. Use of Company Resources and Social Media

Employees must exercise discretion when documenting and sharing event information.

- **Media and Photography:** Employees must exercise caution and good judgment when taking photos or videos at the event, and when sharing event details, photos, or comments on social media platforms.

- **Privacy and Confidentiality:** Do not post photos, videos, or comments that are inappropriate, defamatory, or that violate the privacy of colleagues or clients. Confidential company information must not be discussed or posted publicly.

X. Enforcement and Disciplinary Action

Failure to comply with any section of this Company Event Attendance Policy will result in disciplinary action, which may include:

- Immediate removal from the event

- Formal written warnings.

- Disciplinary action as deemed appropriate by the company